

Weekly dengue data refresh

Standard operating procedure – Dengue Situation Dashboard, CHAI Cambodia

Field	Detail
Frequency	Weekly
Time needed	10-15 minutes
Skills required	Excel, and a web browser
Last reviewed	August 27, 2026

What this is

The dashboard has two halves. The **Cambodia tab** shows national dengue hemorrhagic fever surveillance by province, and is built from an Excel workbook you maintain. The **Global Context tab** shows how Cambodia compares with other countries, and is downloaded automatically from the World Health Organization (WHO).

Your weekly job is only the first half: type the new numbers into Excel, run one file, and upload the result. Everything else is automatic.

You are never editing the website. You edit a spreadsheet, a script turns it into a data file, and you upload that data file. The website itself (index.html) stays untouched week after week.

Before your first run only

Check these once. You will not need to repeat them.

- **Python is installed.** The update script needs it. If double-clicking the update file makes the Microsoft Store open, Python is not properly installed – get it from www.python.org and select “Add Python to PATH” during setup.
- **You can sign in to the GitHub repository** that hosts the site, and you have permission to commit to it.
- **You know the live web address**, so you can confirm your change appeared.
- **You have the project folder** containing `Dengue_Master_Data_Entry.xlsx` and `UPDATE-DASHBOARD.bat`.

The weekly procedure

Step 1: Enter the week's numbers in Excel

Open `Dengue_Master_Data_Entry.xlsx` and go to the **National_Monthly_Entry** sheet. Scroll to the bottom of the data and add one new row per province for the reporting month.

Fill in **only the first five columns**. The rest calculate themselves.

Column	Heading	What to type
A	Province	Must match the spelling in the <code>Lookup_Lists</code> sheet exactly
B	Year	Four digits, for example 2026
C	Month	Three letters, for example Aug
D	Cases	Number of cases that month
E	Deaths	Number of deaths that month
F-H	CFR, Population, IR	Leave alone – these fill in automatically

Province names must match exactly. A typo such as “Kandal ” with a trailing space creates a silent new province that will never appear on the map. Copy the name from `Lookup_Lists` rather than typing it.

Step 2: Run the QA check inside the workbook

Open the **QA_Checklist** sheet. It runs eight automatic checks against what you just entered – missing values, deaths higher than cases, duplicate province-month rows, populations that failed to link, and implausible fatality rates.

Fix anything it flags before moving on. Then save and close the workbook.

Closing matters: the update script reads the saved file from disk. If Excel still has unsaved changes, the script will quietly use last week's numbers and will not warn you.

Step 3: Run `UPDATE-DASHBOARD.bat`

Double-click **UPDATE-DASHBOARD.bat**. A black window opens and works through two steps: your national data first, then the WHO global download. Let it finish – it takes under a minute.

Read the last few lines. There are two possible endings, and both are fine.

What it says	What it means	What to upload
DONE - both updates finished.	Everything refreshed normally.	<code>Data/dengue-data.json</code> and <code>Data/who-dengue-global.json</code>

What it says	What it means	What to upload
DONE - but only partly.	WHO could not be reached – no internet, or their server is down. Your national data still updated correctly.	Data/dengue-data.json only

If it says STOPPED, the national step failed and nothing was saved. Do not upload anything. Read the error printed above it – it is almost always a problem with the spreadsheet. See “When something goes wrong” below.

Step 4: Upload the file to GitHub

1. Open the repository in your browser and click into the Data folder.
2. Click **Add file**, then **Upload files**.
3. Drag in the file or files named in step 3, taken from the Data folder on your computer.
4. Scroll down and click **Commit changes**.

Keep the filenames exactly as they are. GitHub will replace the old versions.

Step 5: Confirm it went live

Wait about a minute, then open the live web address and check that the headline figures match what you entered. If the page still shows old numbers, wait another minute and refresh.

That is the whole weekly task. You do not need to ask anyone to clear their browser cache – the page checks for fresh data every time it loads.

Never do these

- Never edit the data files by hand. The script rewrites them completely each run, so your edit is erased.
- Never re-upload index.html for a routine data update. Only files inside the Data folder change.
- Never rename or delete a province in Lookup_Lists if it is already used in an entry sheet. Adding is safe; renaming breaks history.
- Never rename the sheets in the workbook. The script looks for them by name and will stop if one is missing.
- Never upload after a STOPPED message. Nothing was saved, so you would be re-uploading last week’s file.

When something goes wrong

What you see	What it means	What to do
The Microsoft Store opens	Python is not really installed – Windows ships a placeholder	Install Python from www.python.org , selecting “Add Python to PATH”
Sheet ... not found	A sheet was renamed or deleted in the workbook	Restore the original sheet name exactly
Required file not found	The script has been separated from the Excel file	Keep all the files together in one folder; do not move just a shortcut
Could not reach the WHO API	No internet, or WHO is down. Not yours to fix	Nothing. Your national update is safe – upload it and move on
Numbers on the site look unchanged	Either the commit has not deployed yet, or Excel was left unsaved	Wait two minutes and refresh. If still wrong, redo from step 1
A province is missing from the map	Its name does not match Lookup_Lists – usually a typo or stray space	Correct the spelling in the entry sheet and run the update again

Known limitations to hand on

None of these break anything today, but the next person should know about them.

The week number in the page header is typed by hand

The line reading “DHF Weekly Report – Week 27, 2026” at the top of the dashboard is fixed text inside `index.html`. No script updates it. If that label matters to your audience, edit it manually and upload `index.html` that once.

Age-group comparison has no 2025 baseline

The `National_AgeGroup_Entry` sheet currently holds 2026 rows only, so the “2025 versus 2026 by age” chart draws 2025 as zero – which reads as if nobody of any age caught dengue in 2025. The workbook’s own QA check number 8 already flags this. Adding the four 2025 age rows fixes it.

January 2027 will mislabel every year

The data file names its fields after 2026 and 2025 regardless of the actual year. The first time 2027 data is added, **the numbers will be correct but every label will still say 2026**. Nothing shows an error; it just quietly reads a year behind. Budget a short piece of development work before the new year, so the dashboard derives its year labels from the data.

Where the numbers come from

Half of the dashboard	Source	Updated by
Cambodia tab	National Dengue Control Program (NDCP) dengue hemorrhagic fever weekly bulletin, typed into the Excel workbook. Population from the National Institute of Statistics Population Projection 2020-2033	You, weekly
Global Context tab	WHO Global Dengue Surveillance Dashboard, via its public application programming interface	The script, automatically

The two sources will disagree about Cambodia, and that is expected. WHO receives Cambodia's figures weeks late and revises them. **The Cambodia tab is the number to quote.** Card G6 on the Global Context tab shows the gap year by year rather than hiding it.

This document covers routine weekly operation only. First-time deployment to GitHub Pages is covered in [README.md](#) in the project folder.